Typhoon Champi Brings Storms and a Day Off in Taiwan

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A strong storm called **Typhoon** Champi came close to Taiwan on Friday. A **typhoon** is a powerful storm in this part of the Pacific Ocean, like a **hurricane**.

Hundreds of flights in East Asia were cancelled. Officials said one person died after being swept away by waves, and 171 people were hurt. About 1,000 people left their homes to stay safe.

Earlier this week, Champi was the strongest storm on Earth so far this year, with winds of 185 miles per hour. It later got weaker.

Forecasters expected the center of the storm to pass by without hitting land in Taiwan, but they were not completely sure. Heavy rain was expected until Saturday evening.

Schools and offices closed in almost all of Taiwan. People call this a "**typhoon** holiday." In Japan's Okinawa, about 8,400 homes lost power.

Experts say an unusually strong **El Niño**, a natural warming of the Pacific Ocean, is causing many storms this year.

Word Treasure

typhoon -- A powerful storm in this part of the Pacific Ocean, like a hurricane.

hurricane -- A huge storm with very strong winds that forms over warm ocean water.

forecasters -- Scientists who predict the weather.

El Niño -- A natural warming of the Pacific Ocean that can change the weather.

Background you need

Typhoons are giant spinning storms that form over warm ocean water in the Pacific.

Places like Taiwan close schools and warn people to stay away from the coast so everyone stays safe.

Break it down

WHO: People in Taiwan, Japan and the Philippines, and weather forecasters
WHAT: Typhoon Champi cancelled flights and closed schools and offices
WHERE: Near Taiwan's north-east coast and Japan's Okinawa
WHY: A very strong storm came close, helped by a strong El Niño

Why it matters

Knowing how storms work and listening to weather warnings helps families stay safe.

Test what you remember

1. What is a typhoon?

- (A) A powerful storm, like a hurricane
- (B) A snowstorm
- (C) A kind of earthquake
- (D) A type of boat

2. What happened to hundreds of flights?

- (A) They were free
- (B) They were painted
- (C) They were cancelled
- (D) They went to space

3. How fast were Champi's winds at their strongest?

- (A) 50 miles per hour
- (B) 1,000 miles per hour
- (C) 185 miles per hour
- (D) 10 miles per hour

4. What do people in Taiwan call a day off because of a storm?

- (A) A wind break
- (B) A snow day
- (C) A typhoon holiday
- (D) A rain party

5. About how many homes in Okinawa lost power?

- (A) About 10
- (B) None
- (C) About 8,400
- (D) About 1 million

6. What do experts say is causing many storms this year?

- (A) A strong El Niño
- (B) Snow
- (C) The Moon
- (D) A volcano

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: C 4: C 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Forecasters: Expected the storm's center to pass by Taiwan, but were not completely sure.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):